Leaving the Laptop

General Agents, Chapter 12/12 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/leaving-the-laptop

EN: The final dependency after the Loop/Harness/Checker trilogy: your hardware. This course decides WHERE an agent lives and WHO keeps it alive -- not its behavior (the previous 3 courses already settled that).
Roman Urdu: Trilogy (Loop/Harness/Checker) ke baad aakhri dependency: aapka hardware. Yeh course decide karta agent KAHAN rehta hai aur KAUN usay zinda rakhta hai -- behavior nahi (wo pichli 3 courses tay kar chuki hain).

1. Control Plane + Execution Plane + Four Homes

- Every option is sorted by one question: who operates the agent loop, and where does its work execute? 2 halves: control plane (the loop itself) and execution plane (where actions land).
- **4 Homes:** (1) Your session -- both yours. (2) Cloud schedule -- control yours, execution cloud. (3) Managed runtime -- both vendor's. (4) Your own process -- both yours (Agent SDK, Mode 2).
- Rule: 'only own what's necessary, not what you want.'

2. Headless + Managed Runtime

- Headless mode = agent runs as a command, not a session. New habit: headless runs must fail LOUDLY -- silence must not mean success, you have to enforce that.
- **Minimum Unattended Kit (6 controls):** idempotency, missed-run detection, concurrency lock, credential discipline, time semantics, cost+execution limits.
- Managed runtime (Home 3): you send a definition, the vendor operates it -- but the infra pager is theirs, the business-outcome pager stays yours.

3. Suitcase Test + Choosing a Home

- **What travels with you:** spec, rubric, golden set, ratchet log, maker-checker split, human gate -- decisions, never software.
- **What doesn't travel:** flags, paths, session state, runtime-specific code. Arrival protocol: run the FULL golden set (not a smoke set), read misses by category first, hold bars, record a new runtime-labeled baseline.
- **4 questions to choose a home:** Who's the user? What must you own? Does anyone wait on screen? What's the cost of a bad night?

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
Control plane vs Execution plane	Who runs the loop vs where the actions land.	Loop kaun chalata vs actions kahan land karte.
Headless mode	Running an agent as a command, not an interactive session.	Agent ko command ki tarah chalana, interactive session nahi.
Suitcase Test	What travels when you move homes: decisions (spec/rubric/gate), never software.	Ghar badalne par kya travel karta: decisions (spec/rubric/gate), software nahi.
Arrival protocol	Re-running the FULL golden set and recording a new baseline after a move.	Move ke baad poora golden set dobara chalana aur naya baseline record karna.
Lock-in rate, not event	Lock-in builds up gradually through small vendor-side settings leaks.	Lock-in gradually chhoti vendor-side settings leaks se barhti hai.

Quick Self-Check

Question	Answer
What's the difference between the control plane and the execution plane?	Control plane = who runs the agent loop; execution plane = where its actions actually land -- on a laptop both are one machine, elsewhere they can split.
Why must headless runs fail loudly?	Silence can look like success -- you must enforce loud failure/alerting, since nobody is watching a screen.
What's on the Suitcase Test's 'travels with you' list?	Decisions: spec, rubric, golden set, ratchet log, maker-checker split, human gate -- never software, flags, or runtime-specific code.
What's the arrival protocol after moving to a new home?	Run the full golden set (not a smoke test), read misses by category, hold the bars, then record a new runtime-labeled baseline -- plus a probation period before depending on it.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: Personal Agent Harnesses, Mode 1 Problem-Solving, Mode 2 Manufacturing -- completes the Loop->Harness->Checker->House arc toward a Digital FTE. Full 8 practice moves in 06.

Source: docs/leaving-the-laptop/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.